

Topic 4 – Computers: hardware, processing and software

Students should:		Curriculum reference
4.1	Understand the function of the hardware components of a computer system (central processing unit (CPU), main memory, secondary storage, input and output devices)	CO9.1A, B
4.2	Know that data and instructions are stored in main memory and instructions are executed in the CPU	CO9.1B
4.3	Understand the function of random-access memory (RAM) and read-only memory (ROM)	CO9.1C
4.4	Know that an operating system provides an interface between the machine and the user	CO8.1A

Topic 4 (continued)

Students should:		Curriculum reference
4.5	Understand the purposes of different software categories (application software, utility software, managing files, compression, backing up, anti-malware (anti-virus, anti-spyware))	CO8.1B, C
4.6	Understand why storage devices (hard-disk drives (HDDs), solid-state drives (SSDs), optical discs, pen drives) are used for a particular task	CO9.1D, E
4.7	Understand the difference between storage devices and the media they use to store data (magnetic, optical, solid state)	CO9.1D
4.8	Know the software licensing types (free/open source software and proprietary software)	CO9.2A